

Pear Fritters

with Lemon Glaze

FOR THE LEMON GLAZE

2 cups (240g) powdered sugar
3 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
(about 1 lemon)
1 tablespoon whole milk, plus more if
needed

FOR THE PEAR FRITTERS

4 cups (960ml) vegetable oil, for frying
3 ripe pears (600g), peeled, cored, and
chopped (I like Bartlett)
1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
1½ cups (180g) all-purpose flour
2½ teaspoons baking powder
¾ teaspoon salt
½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
Small pinch of freshly grated nutmeg
⅔ cup (160ml) whole milk, room
temperature
2 large eggs, room temperature
3 tablespoons light brown sugar
2 teaspoons vanilla extract
2 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted

These are one of my favorite weekend treats that I make when-
ever I'm in the mood for something decadent and sweet or when
I want to wow guests with a brunchy dessert moment. They're
essentially the perfect fritter—delicate and soft on the inside,
crisp on the outside, packed with pears, and finished with a zingy
lemon glaze that keeps them from feeling too heavy. And if you're
not already sold, know that these call for no rise time, require
barely any prep besides chopping your fruit, and they fry up in an
instant. **MAKES 18 TO 22 FRITTERS**

MAKE THE GLAZE: In a medium bowl, whisk together the powdered
sugar, lemon juice, and milk. The glaze should be thin enough to easily
drizzle; if not, add more milk until you reach your desired consistency.
Cover with plastic wrap and press the plastic to the surface of the glaze.
Set aside at room temperature.

MAKE THE FRITTERS: Add the oil to a large Dutch oven or heavy pot.
Heat over medium-high heat until a deep-fry thermometer registers 350°F.

Line a baking sheet with paper towels and set a cooling rack on top.
Set aside.

Place the pears in a medium bowl and toss with the lemon juice to coat
well. Set aside.

In a large bowl, whisk together the flour, baking powder, salt, cinnamon,
and nutmeg.

In a medium bowl, whisk together the milk, eggs, brown sugar, and
vanilla. Pour the milk mixture into the flour mixture and use a spatula to
stir the batter until almost combined. Add the pears and melted butter and
mix until well combined.

Use a 2-ounce ice cream scoop or ¼ cup measuring cup to carefully por-
tion the batter into the hot oil. Drop the batter into the oil while slowly
moving your hand in a sweeping motion so that the batter doesn't fall
into one big ball or clump. This will create a whimsical shape with lots of
crispy bits! You'll want to work in batches so as not to cause the oil temper-
ature to drop, which will lead to soggy fritters; I like frying 3 to 4 fritters at
a time. Adjust your heat setting throughout frying if needed to maintain
the proper temperature.

Fry until the fritters are golden brown on the bottom, 3 to 5 minutes. Use
tongs or a kitchen spider to flip the fritters and fry until golden brown on
the other side, about 3 minutes. Transfer the fritters to the prepared cool-
ing rack and repeat with the remaining batter.

continued



TIPS & TRICKS

These fritters are meant to be stuffed with fruit, so don't be concerned if the batter looks like it's mostly chopped pears.

Creating a drip rack with a baking sheet, paper towels, and a wire rack may seem like overkill, but trust me. This setup keeps the oil contained, and you can use the same setup when glazing the fritters.

Don't immediately dispose of your oil—it can be used two to three times for frying, or to season cast-iron pans. Before storing it in a sealed container for reuse, cool the oil then pour it through a coffee filter- or paper towel-lined fine-mesh sieve. This will catch any bits of food still in the oil that can make it go rancid during storage.

When disposing of fryer oil, don't pour it down your drain! I like to save the oil bottle or another disposable container that seals tightly, then pour the cooled oil into the container, seal, and throw it away.

Drizzle the glaze over the hot fritters. Allow a few minutes for excess glaze to drip off the fritters, then serve warm. Cooled fritters can be stored in an airtight container at room temperature for up to 2 days.

Variation

CHANGE UP THE FRUIT: You can substitute apples, peaches, or blueberries for the pears. You want 3½ cups of fruit total.